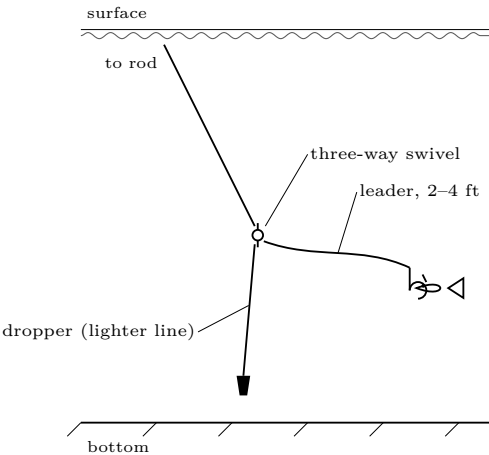


Three-Way Rig

Also called a wolf river rig

Hold a precise depth on a steep face where nothing else will



What it does	Three lines meet at one swivel: the main line up to the rod, a short dropper down to the weight, and a leader out to the bait. The weight tracks the bottom while the bait rides at a fixed height above it.
Versus lindy	A lindy rig lets a fish take line freely. A three-way keeps a rigid, known geometry on a steep slope where a lindy rig would tumble down the face.
Components	Three-way swivel, 8–18 in dropper, 1/2–1 oz bell sinker, 2–4 ft leader, single hook or small crankbait.
Dropper line	Deliberately <i>lighter</i> than the main line. When the sinker wedges in rock, you break off a sinker and keep the fish, the leader and the bait.
Bait	Big minnow, a crawler, or a small floating crankbait that rides up off the bottom.
Catches	Walleye, pike, big smallmouth.

Build it

1. Tie the **main line** to the top eye of the three-way swivel.
2. Tie a short **dropper** of lighter line to the bottom eye, and the **sinker** to its end. Make the dropper as long as you want the bait to ride above the bottom.
3. Tie the **leader** to the third eye, then the hook or lure to the leader.

Fish it

Troll or drift slowly	Move at a walking pace with the sinker just ticking bottom. The rig is designed to be moving.
Vertical line	Keep the line close to straight down. Let line out until you touch bottom, then take up a few inches. Re-check constantly on a slope — that is the whole point of the rig.
Feel for the change	You are following a contour. When the sinker stops touching, you have moved deep; when it drags hard, you have moved shallow. Steer to keep contact.
Set	A steady sweep. The fish usually hooks itself against the moving boat.
Where	Pine spot 3 — the east wall is the exact situation this rig was invented for — and the steep side of the bar at 4 . North spot 3 .

When to use it
On a drop too steep to fish any other way. If you keep losing bottom contact and then plowing, alternately, on a sharp break, this is the rig. It also lets you fish a floating crankbait a fixed 18 inches off the rocks, which is deadly on fall walleye.

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